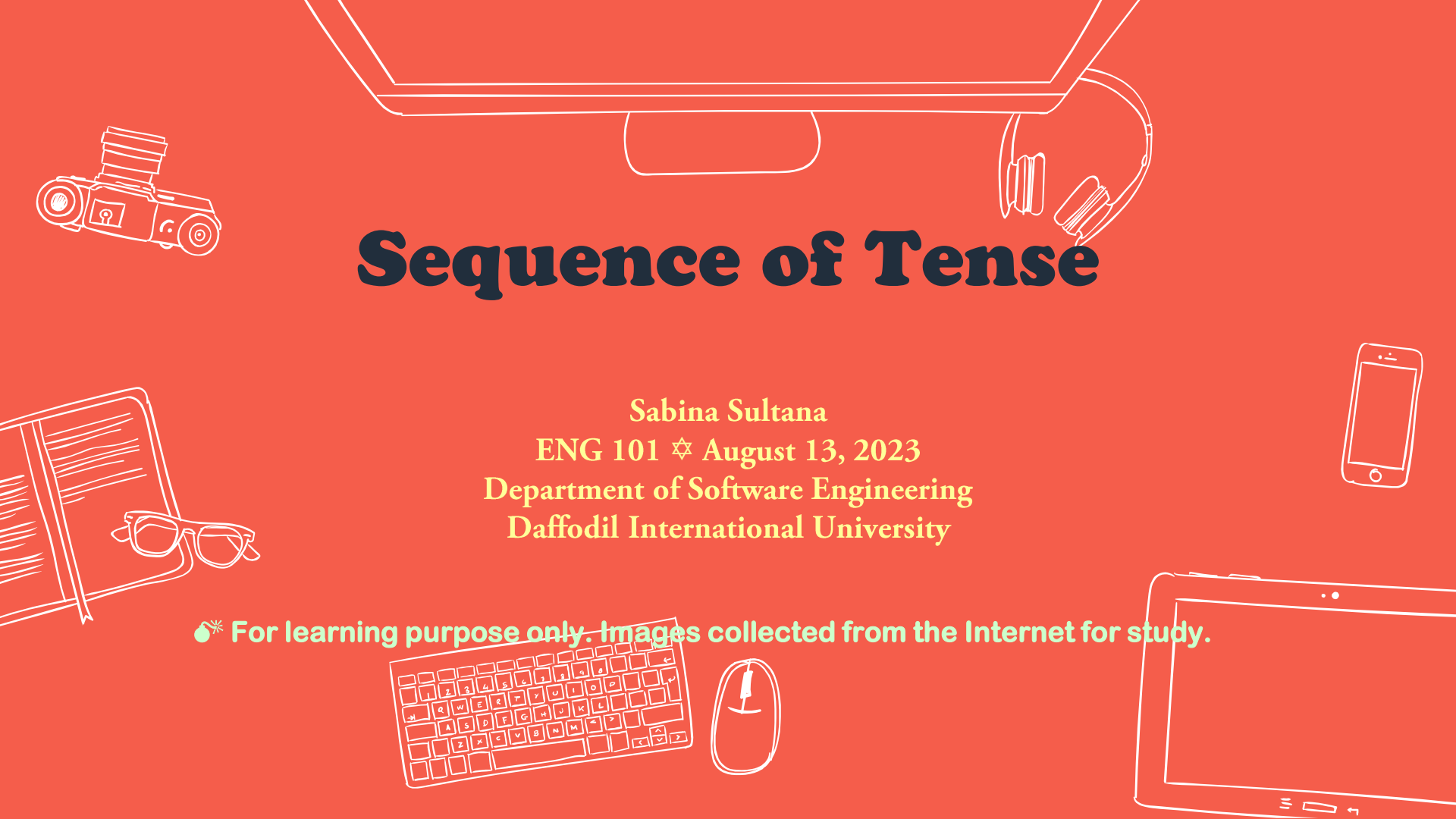




Sequence of Tense

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ENG 101 ☆ August 13, 2023

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💧* For learning purpose only. Images collected from the Internet for study.

Discussion Outline

❖ Sequence of Tense

- Main Verb in the Present
- Main Verb in the Present Perfect
- Main Verb in The Past
- Main Verb in the Past Perfect
- Main Verb Indicating Future
- Main Verb in the Future Perfect

❖ Sequence of Sentences

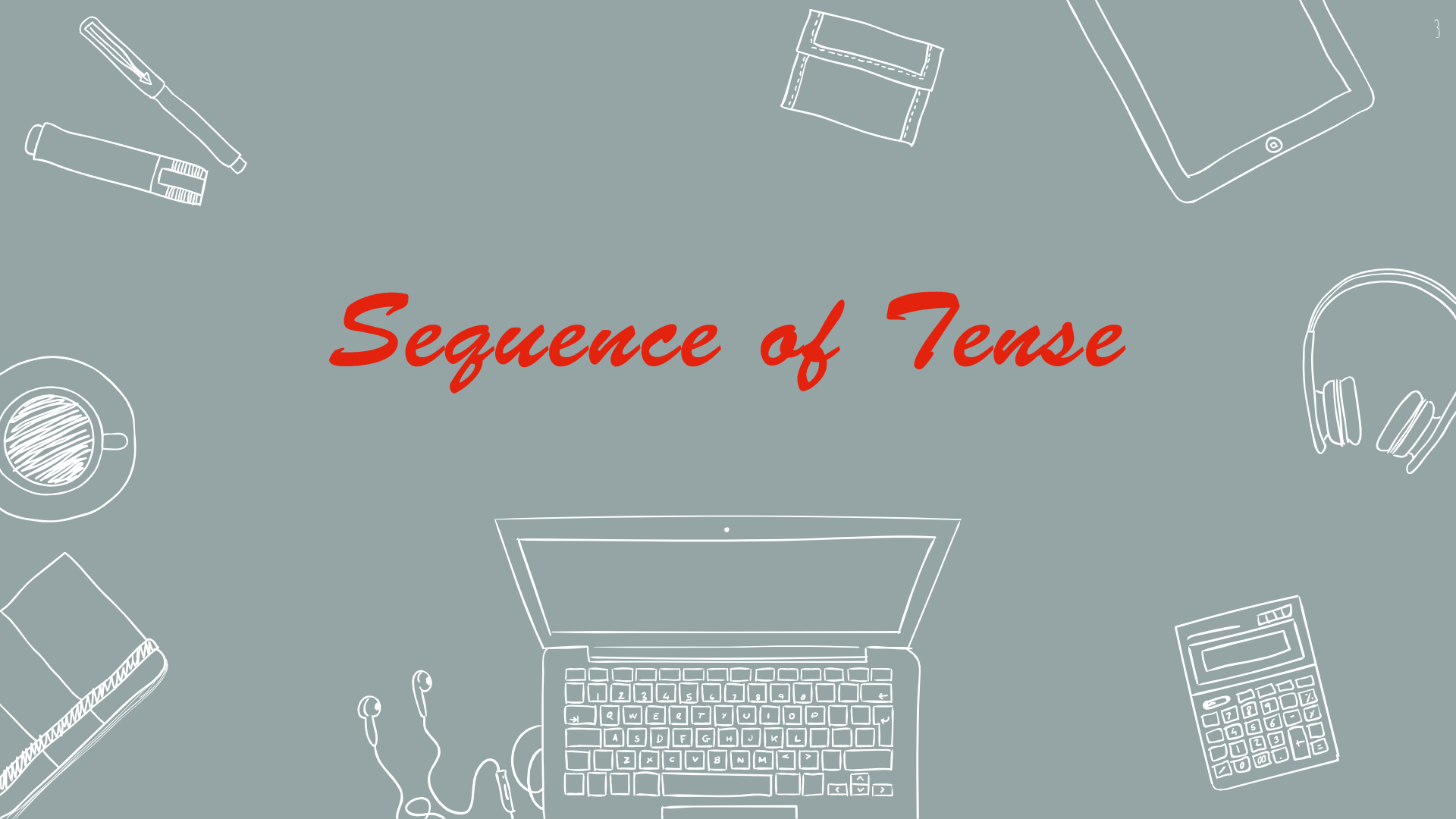
- Compound
- Complex

❖ Run-on Sentence

- Ways to Correct Run-ons

❖ Grammatical Errors

Sequence of Tense

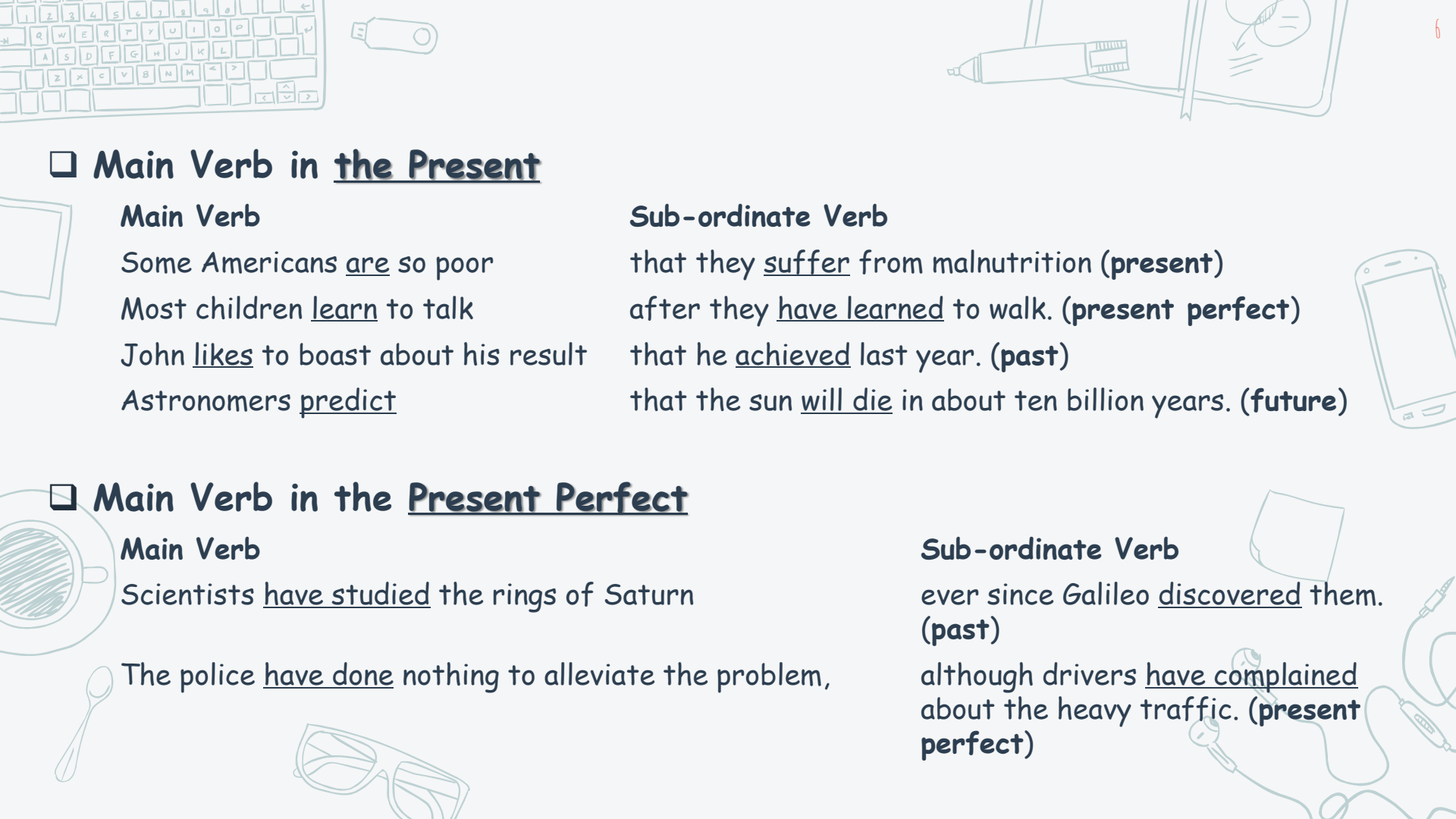


Sequence of Tense

- ❑ When a passage has more than one verb, the relation between the tenses of the verb is called the sequence of tenses.
- ❑ When all the verbs in a sentence describe actions or states that occur at or about the same time, their tenses should be the same:
 - ✓ Ex: “Whenever the alarm clock rings, I yawn, stretch, and roll over for another fifteen minutes of sleep.” (all present tense)
 - ✓ Ex: “She opened her arms to the audience, smiled, and bowed deeply.” (all past tense)

□ If a sentence describe action that happen at different times, it will then have verbs in different tenses:

- ✓ Ex: "Stephen had been working on the research project for almost three years before she made the first discovery." (past perfect continuous and past simple)
- ✓ Ex: "Recently the largest bank of the country lowered its interest rate on loans; the directors want to stimulate borrowing." (past and present)



❑ Main Verb in the Present

Main Verb

Some Americans are so poor

Most children learn to talk

John likes to boast about his result

Astronomers predict

Sub-ordinate Verb

that they suffer from malnutrition (**present**)

after they have learned to walk. (**present perfect**)

that he achieved last year. (**past**)

that the sun will die in about ten billion years. (**future**)

❑ Main Verb in the Present Perfect

Main Verb

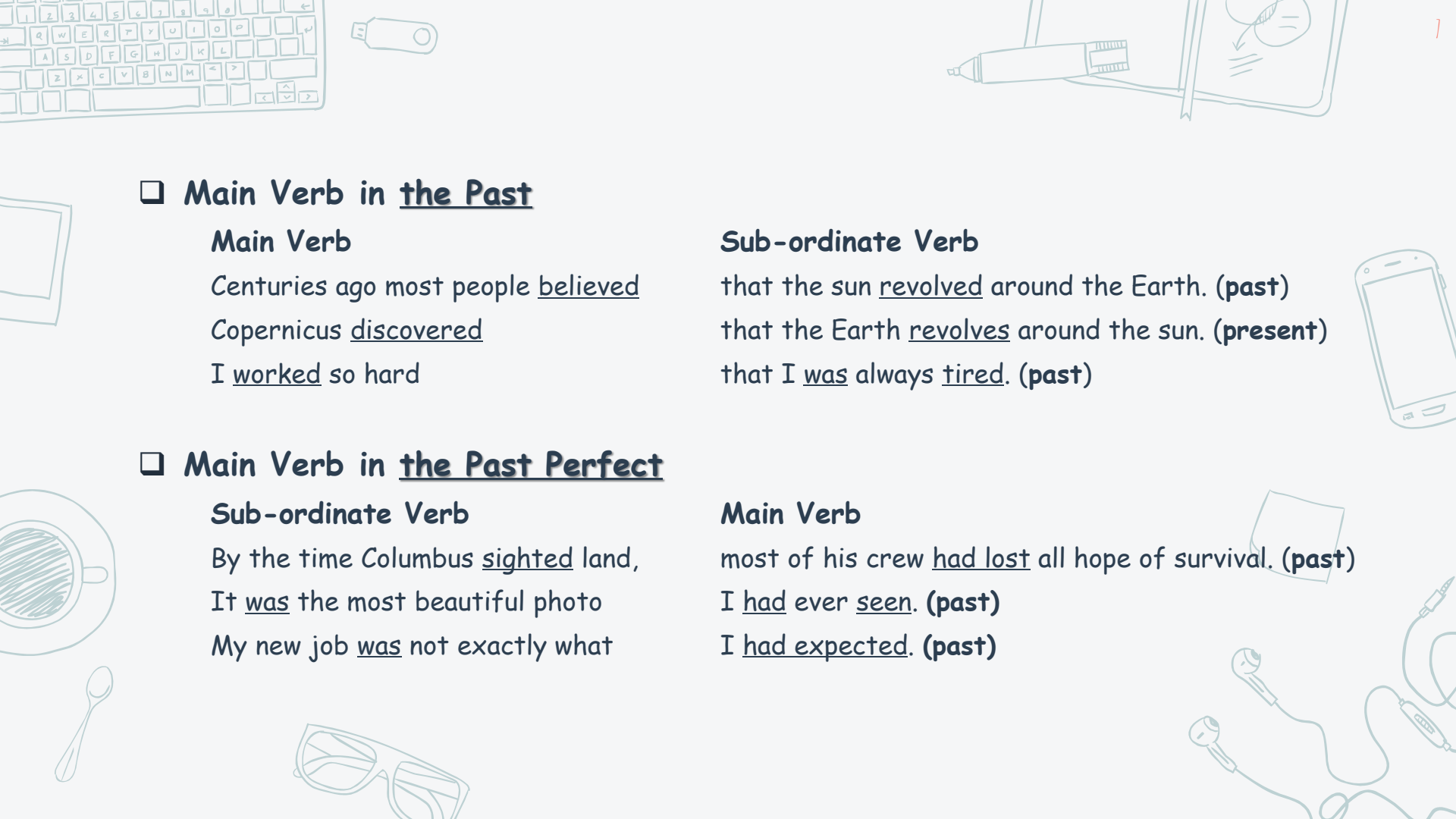
Scientists have studied the rings of Saturn

The police have done nothing to alleviate the problem,

Sub-ordinate Verb

ever since Galileo discovered them.
(**past**)

although drivers have complained
about the heavy traffic. (**present perfect**)



❑ Main Verb in the Past

Main Verb

Centuries ago most people believed

Copernicus discovered

I worked so hard

❑ Main Verb in the Past Perfect

Sub-ordinate Verb

By the time Columbus sighted land,

It was the most beautiful photo

My new job was not exactly what

Sub-ordinate Verb

that the sun revolved around the Earth. (past)

that the Earth revolves around the sun. (present)

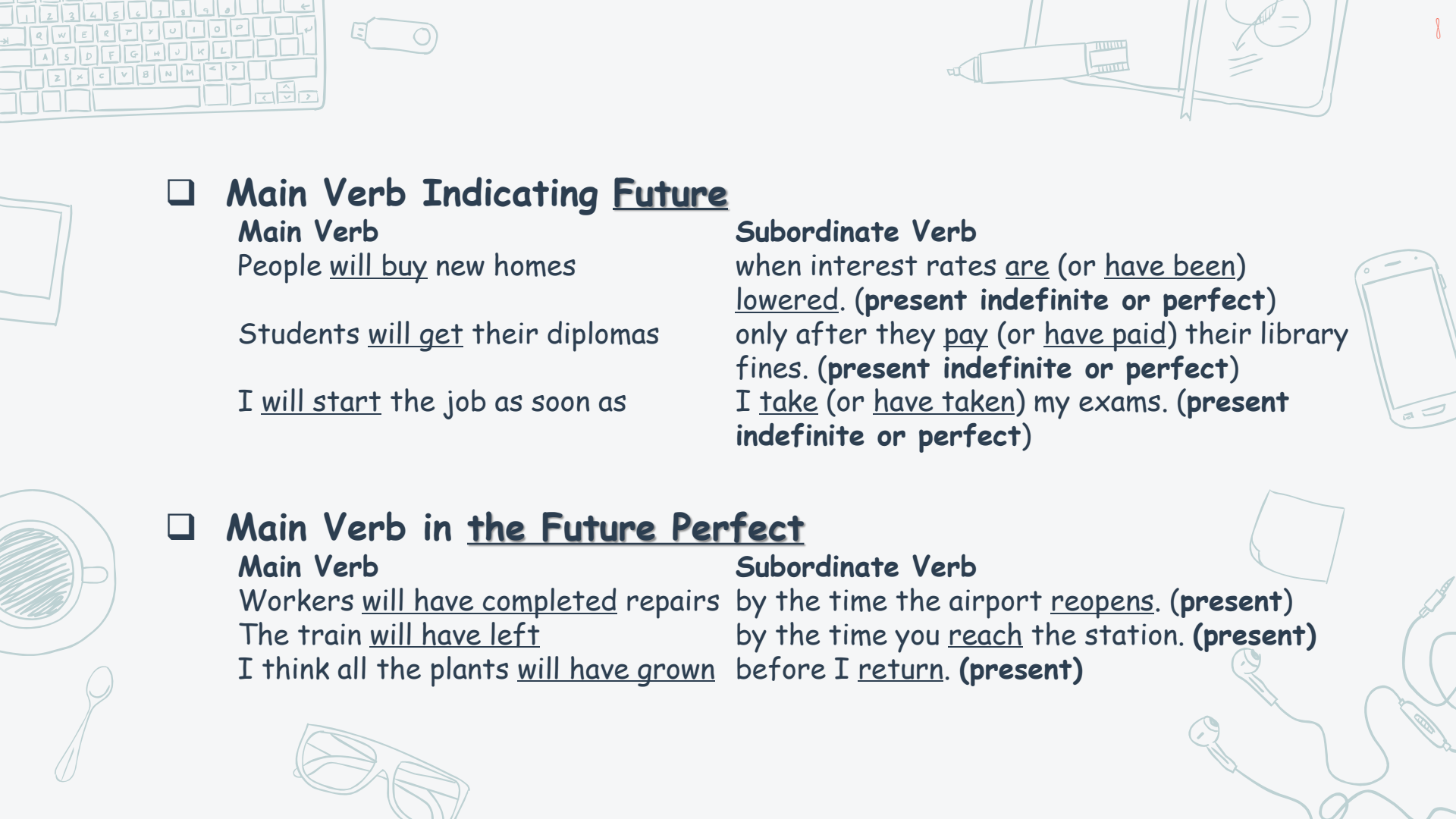
that I was always tired. (past)

Main Verb

most of his crew had lost all hope of survival. (past)

I had ever seen. (past)

I had expected. (past)



❑ Main Verb Indicating Future

Main Verb

People will buy new homes

Students will get their diplomas

I will start the job as soon as

Subordinate Verb

when interest rates are (or have been)
lowered. (**present indefinite or perfect**)
only after they pay (or have paid) their library
fines. (**present indefinite or perfect**)

I take (or have taken) my exams. (**present
indefinite or perfect**)

❑ Main Verb in the Future Perfect

Main Verb

Workers will have completed repairs

The train will have left

I think all the plants will have grown

Subordinate Verb

by the time the airport reopens. (**present**)

by the time you reach the station. (**present**)

before I return. (**present**)



SEQUENCE OF SENTENCES



□ Sequences in Complex Sentences

- A complex sentence consists of one independent clause and at least one subordinate clause.
- In this kind of sentence, which often deals with two different times, many sequences are possible.
- The sequence chiefly depends on the tense of the main verb.
 - ✓ Ex: *While I am a passionate tennis fan, I prefer football.* (both present)
 - ✓ Ex: *Having a party at midnight is a bad idea because the neighbors will complain.* (present and future)
 - ✓ Ex: *Although the pandemic ended, and as people tend to have short memories, the city's people were still divided over its impact.* (past, present, and past)

❑ Sequences in Compound Sentences

- A compound sentence consists of two or more independent clauses. Since the clauses are independent, the tenses of the verbs may be independent from each other.
 - ✓ Ex: *In the past, most Americans wanted big cars, but now many drives small ones.* (past and present)
 - ✓ Ex: *The number of whales is decreasing; as a result, they will be added to the list of endangered species.* (present and future)
 - ✓ Ex: *I wanted a big raise, but I will be getting a small one.* (past and future)

Run-on Sentence



❑ A run-on sentence is the incorrect combination and misuse/incorrect use of punctuation of sentences.

❑ Run-ons are known as fused sentences: they are fused or joined together, as if they were only one thought.

❑ Example:

✗ *We didn't exactly get along she was spreading rumors about me.* (no punctuation)

✓ *We didn't exactly get along. She was spreading rumors about me.*

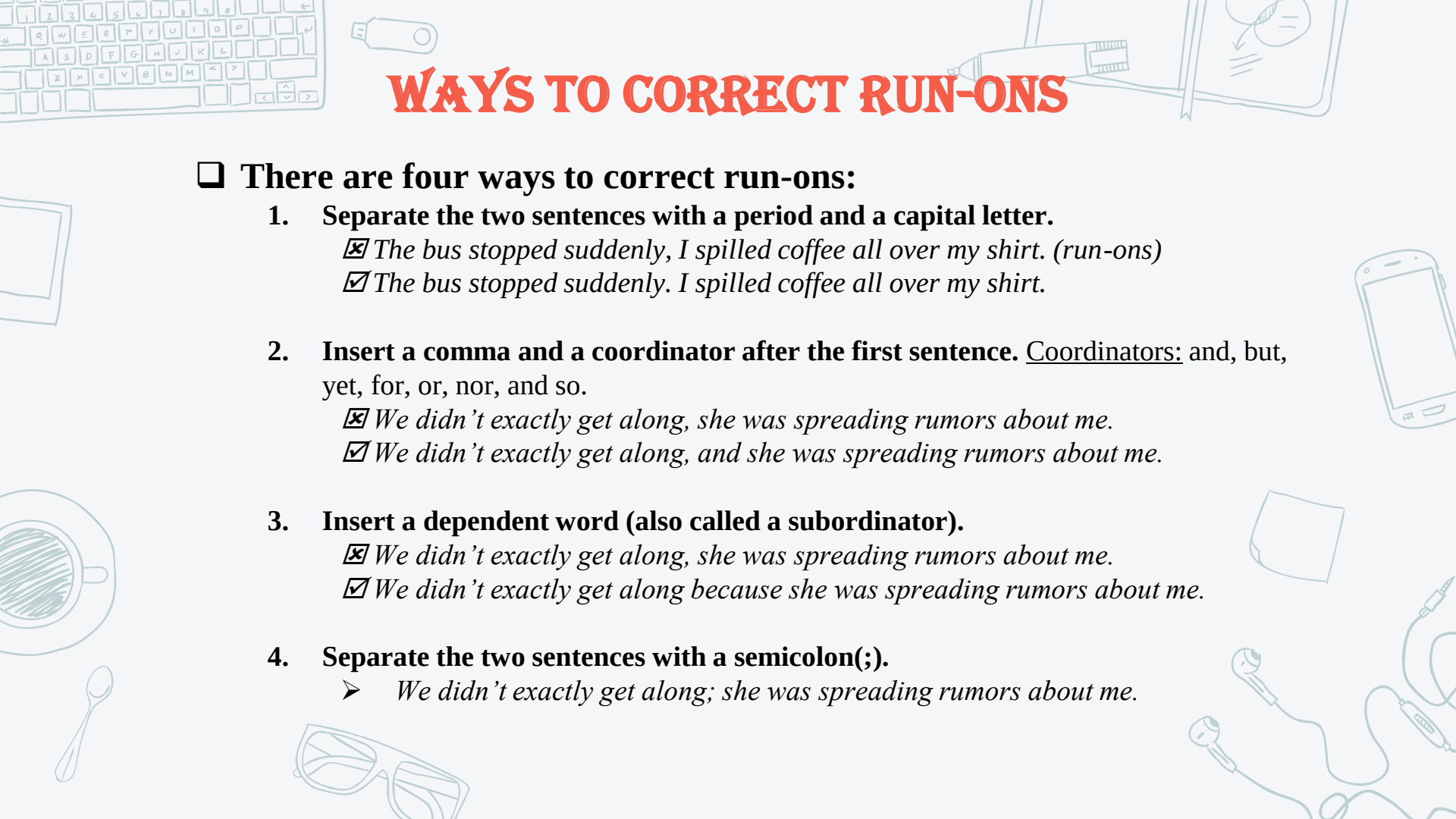
❑ In other run-ons, a comma is used to connect, or 'splice' together two complete thoughts. This is known as *comma splice*.

❑ However, a comma alone is not enough to connect two complete thoughts. Some stronger, clearer marks are needed between the two complete thought.

❑ Example:

✗ *John told everyone in the room to be quiet, his favorite show was on.* (comma alone cannot separate sentences)

✓ *John told everyone in the room to be quiet. His favorite show was on.*



WAYS TO CORRECT RUN-ONS

❑ There are four ways to correct run-ons:

1. Separate the two sentences with a period and a capital letter.

✗ *The bus stopped suddenly, I spilled coffee all over my shirt. (run-ons)*

✓ *The bus stopped suddenly. I spilled coffee all over my shirt.*

2. Insert a comma and a coordinator after the first sentence. Coordinators: and, but, yet, for, or, nor, and so.

✗ *We didn't exactly get along, she was spreading rumors about me.*

✓ *We didn't exactly get along, and she was spreading rumors about me.*

3. Insert a dependent word (also called a subordinator).

✗ *We didn't exactly get along, she was spreading rumors about me.*

✓ *We didn't exactly get along because she was spreading rumors about me.*

4. Separate the two sentences with a semicolon(;).

➤ *We didn't exactly get along; she was spreading rumors about me.*

Grammatical Errors



❑ Grammatical error is a term used in prescriptive grammar to describe an instance of faulty, unconventional, or controversial usage, such as a misplaced modifier or an inappropriate verb or tense.

❑ Also known as: *error, usage error, grammar error or mistake, bad grammar,*

❑ Usually *distinguished from (though sometimes confused with)* factual errors, logical fallacies, misspellings, typographical errors, and faulty punctuation.

Confusing the Infinitive, Gerund or Base Form of the Verb

- I must **to buy** a new cartoon book.
- I must **buy** a new cartoon book.

Wrong Word Usage

- Sally **accepted** her teacher offer to make exam.
- Sally **excepted** her teacher offer to make exam.

Misusing Adverbs and Adjectives

- I want to speak English **good**.
- I want to speak English **well**.

Subject-Verb Agreement

- People **is** coming to my birthday party tomorrow.
- People **are** coming to my birthday party tomorrow.
- Women **has** very important rights in the constitution.
- Women **have** very important rights in the constitution.

Choosing the Wrong Tense

- I **have been** to New York last summer.
- I **went** to New York last summer.



Thanks!

Any questions?

